

CAREER PATHS

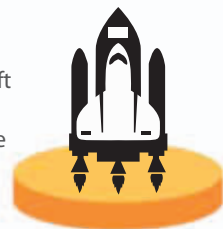
Aerospace engineering offers good prospects for career development. Specializing in a particular area—such as astronautics—is common, and training courses to improve professional skills are possible throughout one's career.

TRAINEE You can find work as an aerospace technician or trainee apprentice without a degree, but further qualifications are required to become an engineer.

GRADUATE You need an aerospace-engineering or related degree to become an aerospace engineer. Many firms offer graduate training programs.



AEROSPACE ENGINEER In this sector, you may specialize in research and development, aircraft systems testing, or maintenance and production. You can advance into senior project management positions or specialize in a particular technical area, such as aerodynamics or aircraft engines.



ASTRONAUTICAL ENGINEER Specializes in the research, design, and development of vehicles for space exploration, including rockets and satellites.

AVIONICS AND SYSTEMS ENGINEER Designs electronic equipment used in civil and military aircraft, such as flight-control and weapon-combat systems.

AERODYNAMICIST Researches the effect of airflow on the speed and performance of vehicles in order to improve stability and fuel-efficiency, and reduce the environmental impact of aircraft.

MATERIALS AND STRUCTURES ENGINEER Designs and builds the body and framework of an aircraft, before testing it to ensure that the structure is strong and durable.

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent verbal and written communication skills to explain complex designs clearly.



The ability to work in a team to coordinate the designs for the numerous parts of an aircraft.



Creativity and innovation to develop designs in keeping with technological advances.



Good problem-solving skills for finding effective solutions to technical design issues.



The capacity to use advanced mathematical methods to assist designing and problem-solving.